

SENATE BILL NO. 95

INTRODUCED BY M. YAKAWICH

A BILL FOR AN ACT ENTITLED: "AN ACT ALLOCATING MONEY FOR SUICIDE PREVENTION EFFORTS
FOR VETERANS AND SERVICE MEMBERS; ESTABLISHING PURPOSES FOR USE OF THE MONEY; AND
PROVIDING AN EFFECTIVE DATE AND A TERMINATION DATE."

BE IT ENACTED BY THE LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF MONTANA:

NEW SECTION. Section 1. Allocation. (1) There is allocated ~~\$500,000~~ \$300,000 from the state
special revenue account established in 17-6-603 to the department of public health and human services for the
biennium beginning July 1, 2025, for grants made pursuant to 53-21-1101 and 53-21-1111 for suicide
prevention activities.

(2) The allocation must be used to:

(a) implement strategies that are developed, with assistance from the U.S. department of veterans
affairs and the federal substance abuse and mental health services administration, as part of the ~~mayor's~~
~~challenge or the governor's challenge~~ MONTANA DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES' CAMPAIGN
to prevent suicide among service members, veterans, and their families;

(b) identify and screen service members, veterans, and their families for suicide risk by:

(i) establishing screening standards for the identification of suicide risk among service members,
veterans, and their families;

(ii) educating providers and peers involved in the intake process; and

(iii) establishing a review process for identification of service members, veterans, and their families
in mortality and data review;

(c) promote connectedness and improve care transitions for service members, veterans, and their
families by:

(i) increasing peers who are trained in suicide prevention to work in connecting those individuals
to services; and

